

The Setup Sheet

Install it, prove it works, and fix it when it does not.

INSTALL IT

macOS or Linux, in Terminal

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

It updates itself from then on. You do this once.

Windows, in PowerShell

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

Your prompt must start with PS. If it does not, you are in Command Prompt and this will fail.

PROVE IT WORKED

Should print a number, then (Claude Code)

```
claude --version
```

Checks your setup without starting anything

```
claude doctor
```

Go to a folder that does not matter, then start

```
claude
```

THE COMMANDS YOU ACTUALLY USE IN WEEK ONE

TYPE THIS	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/help</code>	Everything it can do. Start here when stuck.
<code>/login</code>	Switch accounts, or log in again.
<code>/init</code>	Write the project rules file for this folder.
<code>/memory</code>	Open the rules file and edit what it remembers.
<code>/context</code>	Show what is currently loaded and what it costs.
<code>/hooks</code>	Show which guards are registered. Read only.

WHERE YOU CAN RUN IT

WHERE	GOOD FOR
Desktop app	Never used a terminal. Buttons and windows.
Terminal	How most people use it. Everything works here.
Your editor	VS Code and JetBrains, if you live in one.
The web	Trying it with nothing installed.

READ THIS BEFORE YOU INSTALL

A free Claude.ai account does not include Claude Code. You need Pro, Max, Team or Enterprise, or a Console account with credit on it. This is the number one reason a first install looks broken: it installs perfectly, then will not let you in.

THE FIVE THINGS THAT GO WRONG

command not found

Your terminal was already open when you installed, so it does not know the new command exists. Close it completely, open a new one, try again. Almost never a failed install.

It installs, then will not log in

Check your plan at claude.ai. A free account does not include Claude Code.

Windows: an error mentioning &&

You are in Command Prompt, not PowerShell. Close it, open PowerShell, run the line again.

Windows: it works, but feels limited

Install Git for Windows. Without it Claude Code falls back to PowerShell for running commands, which works but can do less.

Installed, but something still feels wrong

Run claude doctor. It reports what it finds and changes nothing. Read what it says before reinstalling: reinstalling is almost never the answer and costs you ten minutes.

WORTH KNOWING ON DAY ONE

- Minimum machine: macOS 13 or newer, Windows 10 or newer, or a recent Linux, with at least 4 GB of memory.
- Days 1 to 6 work anywhere, including in a browser. From Day 7 you want it on your own computer, because those days create files and run scripts.
- Project rules live in `.claude/settings.json`. Your own live in `~/.claude/settings.json`.
- You never paste a file in. You point it at a folder and ask in normal English. It works out what to open.

YOUR FIRST FIVE MINUTES

1. Go to a folder that does not matter, and start

```
claude
```

2. Ask it something you actually want to know

```
what is in this folder, and what is it for?
```

You never told it which files to open. It went and looked. That is the whole difference from a chat window, in one answer.

3. See the rest

```
/help
```